

July 28, 1945

MEMORANDUM FOR GENERAL CLAY:

It is requested that you attempt to get the Control Council to issue the attached decree, vesting German external assets, as soon as possible. We regard it as most urgent that steps be taken immediately to exercise the power of disposition over these assets.

In your discussion in the Control Council with respect to paragraph (b) of Article I of the decree, you may point out that the U. S. and the U. K. governments have been dealing extensively with the problems involved in connection with German external assets for several years and that their representatives are best qualified to deal with the matter of actually getting hold of such assets. The Board would of course be subject to the directions of the Commission, which in turn would be under the Control Council.

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Edwin W. Pauley

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William L. Clayton

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John J. McCloy